

Executive one-pager

Automating inbound document capture in Accounts Payable

doc-extract-agent · Kessler Industrieteile GmbH (worked example)

≈ €110,000 / yr

of AP capacity freed — handling per document drops from ~4 minutes to under a second.

Situation

A three-person AP & order-desk team keys ~60,000 inbound invoices, order confirmations, and delivery notes into the ERP by hand each year — slow, unscalable, and mistyped figures surface only later as disputes and rework.

The problem, quantified

- **Documents / year:** 60,000 (~250 / business day)
- **Manual handling:** 4 min/doc → 4,000 h/yr = €128,000/yr labour
- **Keying errors:** 3% × 60,000 = 1,800 docs → €45,000/yr
- **Cost of the manual process:** ≈ €173,000/yr

Solution — deterministic pipeline with a confidence gate

Five traced stages per document (detect → header → line_items → totals → confidence). The totals cross-check sums the parsed lines against the stated total; only documents scoring ≥ 0.85 with validated totals auto-post — the rest route to a clerk. Live outcomes on the shipped samples:

Sample	doc_type	confidence	validated	outcome
invoice.txt	invoice	0.94	yes	straight-through
rfq_email.txt	rfq	0.86	—	review
delivery_note.txt	delivery_note	0.86	—	review

Impact / ROI (modeled estimate)

- **Hours/year:** 4,000 h → ~430 h (≈ 3,570 h freed)
- **Labour saving:** ≈ €114,240/yr
- **Error reduction:** ≈ €31,500/yr
- **Total benefit:** ≈ **€145,740/yr**
- **Payback:** ~3 months on labour alone vs. an est. €30k rollout + €500/mo

Recommendation

Pilot the pipeline on live invoices at a 0.85 gate with human review on the tail. Auto-post the ~60% that reconcile, measure the true straight-through rate, then widen coverage. Labour payback lands inside a quarter; error and DSO gains follow.